

The Fedchenko Glacier

The longest glacier in the world outside of the polar regions, flowing through valleys in the Pamir Mountains of Tajikistan



The Fedchenko is an exceptionally long, narrow glacier, whose length has been measured from satellite imagery at 48 miles (77 km)—slightly longer than some other very long nonpolar glaciers, such as the Siachen Glacier and the Baltoro Glacier (see opposite) in the Karakoram mountain range. The Fedchenko Glacier covers a total area of about 270 square miles (700 square km) and has dozens of tributaries. It is located in such a remote part of the world that it remained undiscovered until 1878 and was not fully explored until 1928. Subsequently, it was named after Alexei Fedchenko, a Russian explorer well known for his travels in Central Asia.

▷ NARROW COURSE

Here, the lower part of the glacier snakes diagonally across the landscape from bottom left to top right. A few tributaries can also be seen.



The Yulong Glacier

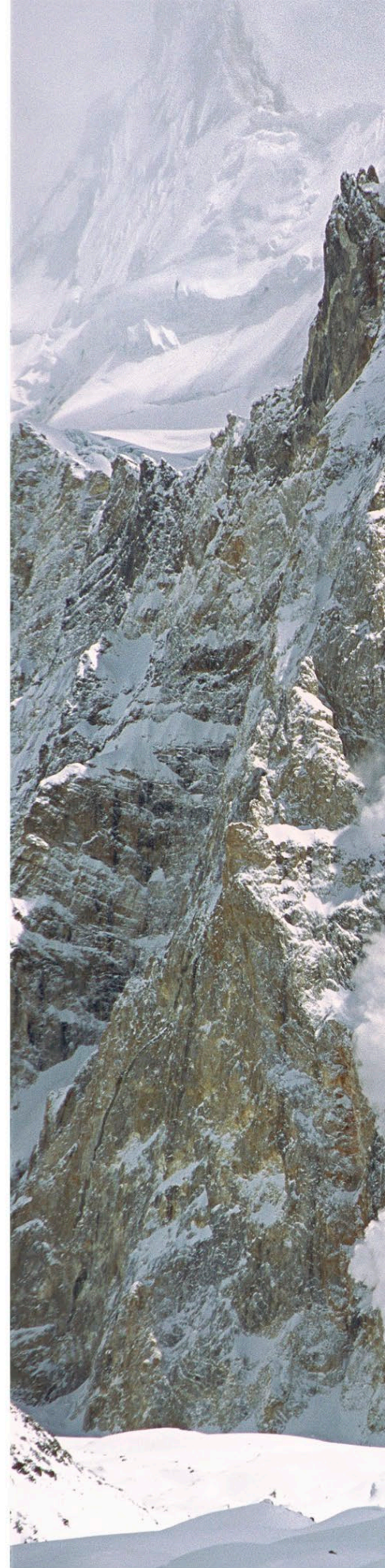
One of the best known glaciers in China, located on Jade Dragon Snow Mountain



The Yulong Glacier is one of 19 small glaciers that adorn the flanks of a massif (a compact group of mountains) in Yunan Province, southwestern China. This massif is known as Mount Yulong or Jade Dragon Snow Mountain. The Yulong Glacier is a cirque glacier (one occupying a depression high up on a mountain) with an extra tongue of ice, called a hanging glacier, below it. It is one of the most accessible glaciers in China because it lies near the top of a cable car route. Unfortunately, the glacier is shrinking, and at its current rate of ice loss it is expected to disappear in about 50 years' time.

▷ CRACKED SURFACE

The steeply descending "hanging" part of the Yulong Glacier, situated at an altitude of about 12,000 ft (3,650 m), has a heavily crevassed, broken-up surface.



△ WHITE FLURRY

A powder snow avalanche falls from one of the peaks in the Gasherbrum group onto the Baltoro Glacier, which is in the foreground.